

THE BUSINESS FUNDING DOCUMENT PREP KIT

Your Complete Guide to Getting Lender-Ready

Business Funding

★ The Ultimate Document Preparation System for Business Owners ★

Stop scrambling when funding opportunities arise.
Get your documents organized NOW — before you need the money.

Contents

1. Funding Document Checklist
 2. Bank Statement Prep Sheet
 3. Business Summary Template
 4. Use-of-Funds Worksheet
 5. Revenue Snapshot Sheet
 6. Debt Overview Worksheet
 7. Folder Organization Guide
 8. Application Readiness Checklist
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SECTION 1: FUNDING DOCUMENT CHECKLIST



Complete Documentation Requirements

Pro Tip: Gather these documents 60-90 days before applying for funding. Lenders appreciate businesses that are organized and prepared.

Personal Documentation

Document	Status	Notes
Government-Issued Photo ID (Driver's License or Passport)	☐	Current and not expired
Social Security Card	☐	Required for some applications
Personal Tax Returns (Last 2 Years)	☐	1040 forms including all schedules
Personal Bank Statements (Last 3 Months)	☐	All pages, all accounts
Personal Credit Report	☐	Pull from AnnualCreditReport.com

Business Documentation

Document	Status	Notes
Business License / Registration	☐	State and local if required
Articles of Incorporation / Organization	☐	Original filed documents
EIN Confirmation Letter	☐	From the IRS
Operating Agreement / Bylaws	☐	If applicable to your structure
Business Plan	☐	Comprehensive and professional

Financial Documentation

Document	Status	Notes
Business Tax Returns (Last 2 Years)	☐	All business returns filed
Profit & Loss Statements (Last 12 Months)	☐	Monthly breakdown
Balance Sheet (Current)	☐	Most recent available
Cash Flow Statements (Last 6 Months)	☐	Monthly detail
Accounts Payable/Receivable Aging Reports	☐	Current

Banking Documentation

Document	Status	Notes
Business Bank Statements (Last 6 Months)	☐	All pages, all accounts
Merchant Processing Statements	☐	If applicable
Voided Business Check	☐	For ACH setup
Bank Relationship Letters	☐	If you have established credit



Funding Source Requirements Matrix

Traditional Bank Loans

Requirement	Priority	Notes
Credit Score	☐ 680+	Personal guarantee likely required
Time in Business	☐ 2+ years	Startup programs available
Annual Revenue	☐ \$100K+	Varies by loan type
Collateral	☐ Required	Business or personal assets
Documentation	☐ Extensive	Full financial package

SBA Loans

Requirement	Priority	Notes
Credit Score	☐ 650+	Stronger consideration
Time in Business	☐ 2+ years	Some programs 6 months
Annual Revenue	☐ Varies	Based on program type
Collateral	☐ Usually required	Personal guarantee standard
Documentation	☐ Comprehensive	Detailed business plan needed

Alternative Lenders

Requirement	Priority	Notes
Credit Score	☐ 580+	More flexible options
Time in Business	☐ 6+ months	Many programs available
Annual Revenue	☐ \$50K+	For larger facilities
Collateral	☐ Sometimes	Invoice or equipment financing
Documentation	☐ Moderate	Streamlined process

Remember: Missing documentation is the #1 reason loan applications get delayed or denied. Complete this checklist before you apply.

SECTION 2: BANK STATEMENT PREP SHEET



Preparing Your Bank Statements for Lender Review

Why Bank Statements Matter

Lenders analyze your bank statements to verify:

- **Cash Flow Consistency** — Regular deposits and stable balances
- **** Business Revenue Verification**** — Income matches reported figures
- **Expense Management** — Reasonable and appropriate spending
- **Cash Reserve Maintenance** — Ability to cover obligations
- **Payment History** — How you handle financial relationships



Pre-Submission Checklist

Before Submitting, Ensure:

Task	Complete
Request all pages (front and back) of statements	☐
Verify all transactions are legible	☐
Remove or redact any personal transactions you prefer not to share	☐
Ensure business name matches exactly on all statements	☐
Verify dates cover the required period (typically 6-12 months)	☐
Calculate average monthly balances for each statement	☐
Note any large deposits or withdrawals	☐
Identify any returned deposits or overdrafts	☐



Monthly Balance Analysis Template

Complete for Each Statement Period:

Month: ____ Year: _____

Week	Ending Date	Balance	Notes
Week 1			
Week 2			
Week 3			
Week 4			
Week 5 (if applicable)			

Monthly Summary:

- Starting Balance: \$__
- Ending Balance: \$__
- Total Deposits: \$__
- Total Withdrawals: \$__
- Average Daily Balance: \$____



Red Flags to Address Before Submission

Things Lenders May Question:

Issue	Action to Take
Large Unexplained Deposits	Provide documentation or explanation letter
Significant Balance Fluctuations	Prepare narrative explaining irregular pattern
NSF/Overdraft Fees	Document as one-time occurrence if applicable
Pattern of Low Balances	Show business seasonality or planning
Large Cash Withdrawals	Prepare receipts and business justification
Irregular Deposit Pattern	Explain industry payment cycles

Pro Tip: Create a summary document that highlights the positive aspects of your banking history. Lenders appreciate borrowers who present their financial story proactively.



Explanation Letter Template

Use this format when explaining unusual transactions:

Date: _____

To Whom It May Concern:

This letter explains unusual transactions appearing on my business bank statements for the period ending _____.

Transaction Description: _____

Date: ____ **Amount:** \$_____

Explanation: _____

Supporting documentation attached: ☐

Business Name: _____

Owner Name: _____

Contact Information: _____

SECTION 3: BUSINESS SUMMARY TEMPLATE



One-Page Business Overview for Lenders

Include This Essential Information:

BUSINESS IDENTIFICATION

Field	Information
Legal Business Name	_____
DBA (If Applicable)	_____
Business Structure	☐ LLC ☐ Corporation ☐ Partnership ☐ Sole Proprietorship
Industry	_____
Year Established	_____
State of Incorporation	_____
Federal EIN	_____
Business Address	_____
Phone Number	_____
Email Address	_____
Website	_____

BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

Write a concise 2-3 paragraph description of your business including:

What you do:

Who you serve:

What makes you unique:

OWNERSHIP INFORMATION

Owner Name	Ownership %	Role	SSN (Last 4)
			XXX-XX-____
			XXX-XX-____
			XXX-XX-____
			XXX-XX-____

FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS

Metric	Current Year	Prior Year
Annual Revenue		
Gross Profit		
Net Operating Income		
Total Assets		
Total Liabilities		
Owner Equity		

FUNDING REQUEST SUMMARY

Element	Details
Amount Requested	\$
Purpose of Funds	
Requested Term	☐ Short-term ☐ Medium-term ☐ Long-term
Collateral Available	☐ Yes ☐ No
Requested Rate Range	%

KEY STRENGTHS

List 3-5 key strengths that make your business a good credit risk:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

CHALLENGES &Mitigation

Briefly explain any challenges and how you address them:

Challenge	Mitigation Strategy

Remember: Keep this summary to one page. Lenders appreciate concise, well-organized information that can be quickly reviewed.

SECTION 4: USE-OF-FUNDS WORKSHEET

 Detailed Allocation Plan for Requested Capital

Why This Matters to Lenders

A clear use-of-funds plan demonstrates:

- **Purpose Clarity** — You have specific, defined objectives
- **Strategic Thinking** — You've planned how capital will generate returns
- **Risk Management** — You understand how funds will be deployed safely
- **Return on Investment Focus** — You're using borrowed money productively



FUNDING ALLOCATION MATRIX

Complete the following breakdown:

Category	Description	Amount	% of Total	Expected ROI
Equipment & Assets				
	Technology Upgrades	\$	%	
	Machinery & Equipment	\$	%	
	Vehicles	\$	%	
	Furniture & Fixtures	\$	%	
Working Capital				
	Inventory	\$	%	
	Accounts Receivable	\$	%	
	Operating Expenses	\$	%	
Growth Initiatives				
	Marketing & Advertising	\$	%	
	Staffing & Hiring	\$	%	
	Expansion	\$	%	
Debt Refinancing				
	Existing Loan Payoff	\$	%	
	Credit Card Payoff	\$	%	
Other				
	(Specify)	\$	%	
TOTAL		\$	100%	



DETAILED CATEGORY DESCRIPTIONS

For each major category, provide detail:

Equipment & Assets

What equipment/assets will you purchase?

Why is this equipment necessary for business growth?

How will this equipment increase revenue or efficiency?

Working Capital

Current monthly revenue: \$ __

Projected monthly revenue after funding: \$ __

How will additional working capital be deployed?

Expected timeline for revenue increase: ____ months

Growth Initiatives

Describe specific growth initiatives:

Marketing strategies to be funded:

Hiring plans and positions:

Debt Refinancing

Total current debt payments: \$ __ per month

Projected new payment: \$ __ per month

Monthly savings: \$ ____

How will savings be reallocated?



PROJECTED IMPACT SUMMARY

Fill in your projections:

Metric	Current State	After Funding	Change
Monthly Revenue		+\$	
Monthly Profit		+\$	
Number of Employees			+

Metric	Current State	After Funding	Change
Customer Acquisition Rate			+%
Operational Efficiency			+%

Pro Tip: Lenders want to see that borrowed funds will generate sufficient returns to repay the loan while improving your business. Be specific about expected outcomes.

SECTION 5: REVENUE SNAPSHOT SHEET

Financial Performance Overview

Monthly Revenue Breakdown

Last 12 Months

Month	Revenue	Cost of Goods	Gross Profit	Expenses	Net Income
January			\$		
February			\$		
March			\$		
April			\$		
May			\$		
June			\$		
July			\$		
August			\$		
September			\$		
October			\$		
November			\$		
December			\$		

Month	Revenue	Cost of Goods	Gross Profit	Expenses	Net Income
TOTAL			\$		

Revenue Streams Analysis

Revenue Source	Monthly Average	% of Total	Seasonality
Product Sales	\$	%	☐ High ☐ Low ☐ Steady
Service Revenue	\$	%	☐ High ☐ Low ☐ Steady
Subscription/Recurring	\$	%	☐ High ☐ Low ☐ Steady
Contract Work	\$	%	☐ High ☐ Low ☐ Steady
Other	\$	%	☐ High ☐ Low ☐ Steady

Year-over-Year Comparison

Metric	This Year	Last Year	Change	% Change
Annual Revenue		\$	%	
Annual Gross Profit		\$	%	
Annual Expenses		\$	%	
Annual Net Income		\$	%	

Key Revenue Metrics

Metric	Value
Average Monthly Revenue	\$
Highest Month Revenue	\$ (Month: _____)
Lowest Month Revenue	\$ (Month: _____)
Revenue Growth Rate (YoY)	%
Gross Profit Margin	%
Net Profit Margin	%

Metric	Value
Revenue per Customer	\$

Revenue Concentration Risk

Customer	Annual Revenue	% of Total
Customer A	\$	%
Customer B	\$	%
Customer C	\$	%
Customer D	\$	%
Customer E	\$	%
Top 5 Total	\$	%

Pro Tip: Diversified revenue streams are viewed favorably by lenders. If you have concentration risk, explain your strategy to diversify.

SECTION 6: DEBT OVERVIEW WORKSHEET



Complete Picture of Business Obligations

Purpose of This Document

Lenders need to understand:

- **Total Debt Load** — Your current financial obligations
- **Payment History** — How reliably you handle debt
- **Debt Structure** — Types and terms of existing credit
- **Capacity for Additional Debt** — Your ability to take on more
- **Collateral Position** — Assets securing existing loans



CURRENT BUSINESS DEBT SCHEDULE

Creditor	Original Amount	Current Balance	Interest Rate	Monthly Payment	Maturity Date	Collateral
		%	\$			
		%	\$			
		%	\$			
		%	\$			
		%	\$			
TOTAL			\$			



DEBT RATIO ANALYSIS

Metric	Calculation	Your Value
Total Debt	Sum of all business debt	\$
Annual Debt Service	Monthly payments $\times$ 12	\$
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Net Operating Income $\div$ Annual Debt Service	____ : 1
Debt-to-Asset Ratio	Total Debt $\div$ Total Assets	%
Debt-to-Revenue Ratio	Total Debt $\div$ Annual Revenue	%

Credit Score Summary

Type	Score	Last Updated
Business Credit Score (D&B, Experian, Equifax)		
Personal Credit Score (Owner 1)		
Personal Credit Score (Owner 2)		



PAYMENT HISTORY SUMMARY

Last 12 Months

Month	Total Payments Due	Amount Paid	On Time?	Late?
January		☐	☐	
February		☐	☐	
March		☐	☐	
April		☐	☐	
May		☐	☐	
June		☐	☐	
July		☐	☐	
August		☐	☐	
September		☐	☐	
October		☐	☐	
November		☐	☐	
December		☐	☐	

On-Time Payment Rate: _____%



PERSONAL GUARANTEES

Debt	Guarantor	Amount Guaranteed
		\$
		\$
		\$

Important: Be honest about payment issues. Lenders will find this information anyway, and explaining past challenges with context is better than appearing to hide problems.

SECTION 7: FOLDER ORGANIZATION GUIDE

Physical and Digital Document Organization System

Why Organization Matters

Professional Appearance — Lenders notice when businesses are disorganized

Faster Processing — Complete packages get reviewed faster

Confidence Building — Organized documentation demonstrates professionalism

Problem Prevention — Reduces errors and missing information

PHYSICAL FILE SYSTEM

Create these main folders:

Folder	Contents	Tab Color
1. Business Formation	Articles, EIN, licenses, agreements	☐ Blue
2. Financial Statements	Tax returns, P&L, balance sheets	☐ Green
3. Bank Statements	All accounts, all months	☐ Yellow
4. Debt Documents	Loans, credit cards, leases	☐ Red
5. Insurance	Policies, claims history	☐ Orange
6. Contracts	Vendor, customer, lease agreements	☐ Purple
7. Tax Records	All filed returns, correspondence	☐ Brown
8. Licenses & Permits	All business licenses	☐ Gray

Inside Each Folder, Create Sub-Folders:

Example Structure:

```

├─ Financial Statements (Main Folder)
│   ├── 2023 Tax Returns
│   ├── 2022 Tax Returns
│   ├── Monthly P&L Statements
│   │   ├── January 2023
│   │   ├── February 2023
│   │   └── ...
│   ├── Balance Sheets
│   └── Financial Projections

```



DIGITAL FILE SYSTEM

Recommended Folder Structure:

Main Folder	Sub-Folders	Files
Business_Funding		Master folder
├─ 01_Formation		Articles, EIN, licenses
├─ 02_Financials	Annual, Monthly, Projections	Statements, returns
├─ 03_Banking	Statements, Correspondence	Bank records
├─ 04_Debt	Active, Paid-Off, Applications	Loan documents
├─ 05_Insurance	Current, Historical	Policy documents
├─ 06_Contracts	Vendors, Customers, Leases	All agreements
├─ 07_Tax	Federal, State, Annual filings	Tax records
└─ 08_Licenses	Federal, State, Local	Permits, licenses

File Naming Convention

Use consistent naming: `YYMMDD_DocumentType_BusinessName.ext`

Examples:

- `230101_TaxReturn_ABCBusiness.pdf`
- `230315_BankStatement_ABCBusiness.pdf`
- `230520_LoanApp_ABCBusiness.pdf`



SECURITY & BACKUP

Task	Schedule	Method
Cloud Backup	Weekly	Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud
Physical Backup	Monthly	External drive stored off-site
Document Scanning	Weekly	Scan all new documents
Password Management	Monthly review	Secure password vault
Access Log	Quarterly	Track who has document access

Pro Tip: Keep a master checklist inside each folder listing all documents contained within. This makes it easy to verify completeness.

SECTION 8: APPLICATION READINESS CHECKLIST



Final Review Before Submitting

PRE-SUBMISSION VERIFICATION

Step 1: Document Completeness

Document	Required	Have It	Updated	Organized
Business License	☐	☐	☐	☐
Articles of Incorporation	☐	☐	☐	☐
EIN Confirmation	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business Tax Returns (2 yr)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal Tax Returns (2 yr)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Financial Statements	☐	☐	☐	☐

Document	Required	Have It	Updated	Organized
Bank Statements (6 mo)	☐	☐	☐	☐
Debt Documentation	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business Plan	☐	☐	☐	☐
Personal ID	☐	☐	☐	☐

Step 2: Information Consistency

Verification Item	Checked
Business name matches exactly on all documents	☐
Address consistent across all records	☐
EIN correct on all tax documents	☐
Dates and years align properly	☐
Owner names match across all documents	☐
Financial figures consistent between statements	☐
Debt amounts match creditor records	☐

Step 3: Format Requirements

Requirement	Verified
All documents in required format (PDF, JPEG, etc.)	☐
Files properly named	☐
File sizes within submission limits	☐
Scans are legible and complete	☐
Documents in correct order	☐
Copies of original documents (if required)	☐

Step 4: Lender-Specific Requirements

Requirement	Verified
Score meets minimum requirement	☐
Time in business meets minimum	☐
Revenue meets minimum	☐
Industry eligible for program	☐
Use of funds acceptable for lender	☐
Collateral available (if required)	☐



FINAL PACKAGE CHECKLIST

Package Contents:

Component	Included	Pages
Cover Letter	☐	
Business Summary	☐	
Funding Request Form	☐	
Use of Funds Statement	☐	
Business Tax Returns	☐	
Personal Tax Returns	☐	
Financial Statements	☐	
Bank Statements	☐	
Debt Documentation	☐	
Business Formation Docs	☐	
Personal Financial Statement	☐	
Personal ID Copies	☐	
Business Plan	☐	
Additional Supporting Docs	☐	

READY TO SUBMIT

Final Confirmation:

Task	Complete
All documents collected	☐
All documents organized	☐
All documents reviewed for accuracy	☐
Copies made for your records	☐
Application filled completely	☐
Signed and dated where required	☐
Submitted through correct channel	☐
Confirmation received	☐

Congratulations! If you've completed this checklist, your application package is ready for submission. Keep copies of everything and track your submission date.

NEXT STEPS AFTER SUBMISSION

Timeline	Action
1-2 Weeks	Expect initial review
2-4 Weeks	May receive follow-up questions
4-6 Weeks	Decision typically communicated
Upon Approval	Review terms before signing
Post-Funding	Implement use-of-funds plan



TRACKING SHEET

Submission Date	Lender Name	Amount Requested	Status	Notes
		\$	☐ Pending ☐ Approved ☐ Denied	
		\$	☐ Pending ☐ Approved ☐ Denied	
		\$	☐ Pending ☐ Approved ☐ Denied	
		\$	☐ Pending ☐ Approved ☐ Denied	

Remember: Even if denied, ask for feedback. Each application teaches you what lenders are looking for.

FINAL NOTES

This document preparation kit is designed to help you present your business in the best possible light to lenders. Complete documentation and professional presentation significantly improve your chances of approval.

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For more resources and updates, keep this kit updated as your business evolves.